Example Gulf Coast Baptist Hospital

Patient Financial Assistance Policy

Effective date: January 1, 2025

1. Purpose

Example Gulf Coast Baptist Hospital is committed to providing financial assistance to patients who are uninsured, underinsured, or otherwise unable to pay for emergency and other medically necessary care, consistent with Section 501(r) of the Internal Revenue Code and applicable Texas law.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to emergency and other medically necessary care provided by Example Gulf Coast Baptist Hospital.

This Policy does not cover services covered by a third-party liability settlement.

A list of providers who deliver care in the Hospital, showing which providers are and are not covered by this Policy, is in Exhibit C, Provider Listing.

3. Definitions

3.1 Household. For purposes of this Policy, the household includes the patient, spouse or domestic partner, and dependent children.

3.2 Income. Household income means the household's total gross annual income before taxes and deductions.

3.3 Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG). Eligibility is determined using the Federal Poverty Guidelines in effect on the date of service.

3.4 Medically necessary care. Care that is reasonable and necessary to diagnose or treat an illness or injury, as determined by the treating provider.

4. Eligibility for Financial Assistance

4.1 Patients may qualify for financial assistance if household income is at or below 300% of the FPG and the other conditions of this Policy are met.

Patients with household income at or below 200% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines qualify for free care, a 100% discount.

Patients with household income above 200% and at or below 300% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines receive a 50% discount from gross charges.

5. Other Eligibility Conditions

5.1 Assets. The Hospital does not consider assets when determining eligibility.

5.2 Residency. There is no residency requirement for financial assistance.

5.3 Insurance. Insured patients are eligible for assistance with deductibles, co-insurance and other balances after insurance. Patients whose out-of-pocket medical bills for the prior 12 months exceed 20% of household income also qualify for a discount, regardless of insurance status.

5.4 Other programs. Patients who appear likely to qualify for Medicaid must apply for Medicaid before financial assistance is approved.

6. How to Apply

6.1 Application period. Patients may apply at any time within 240 days after the date of the first post-discharge billing statement.

6.2 Required documents. Applicants must attach the following documents:

(a) the last two pay stubs;

(b) the most recent federal tax return;

(c) a letter of support if the household reports no income;

6.3 Where to apply. Completed applications may be submitted:

- By mail to Financial Counseling, 3080 Example College Street, Beaumont, TX 77701.

- In person at Financial Counseling office, Monday through Friday.

6.4 Determination. The Hospital will notify the patient in writing of its determination and the basis for the determination.

6.5 Award period. Approved financial assistance applies to eligible care for 12 months from the date of determination.

7. Billing and Collections

7.1 Amounts generally billed (AGB). The Hospital calculates amounts generally billed using the look-back method based on Medicare fee-for-service and all private health insurers. The current AGB percentage is 30.2% of gross charges.

7.2 Presumptive eligibility. The Hospital may, at its sole discretion, consider presumptive eligibility for patients experiencing homelessness or patients who are deceased with no estate.

7.3 Screening. The Hospital screens patients for financial assistance after billing and before referring any account to collections.

7.4 Refunds. The Hospital will refund payments that exceed the patient's responsibility after assistance is applied.

7.5 Collections. The Hospital will not engage in extraordinary collection actions before making reasonable efforts to determine whether a patient is eligible for financial assistance. The Billing and Collections Policy is available free of charge.

Questions: call (409) 555-0500 or write to Financial Counseling, 3080 Example College Street, Beaumont, TX 77701.